

Presentations

Introduction

A presentation is the act of **showing and explaining information** to an audience. It often includes **text, charts, graphs, photos, or other visuals** to make the topic easier to understand.

Presentations usually happen in **formal settings** such as workshops, conferences, classrooms, or meetings.

Today, presentations are also supported by modern tools like **Zoom, Teams, projectors, and interactive whiteboards** to make them clearer and more interesting.

Example:

A teacher uses slides with pictures and graphs to explain climate change to students.

Getting Started with Presentations

Imagine your company created a new product. To convince management to support the idea, you must **explain the product, show its benefits, and persuade them**.

This chapter teaches how to **plan, organize, prepare, and deliver** effective presentations.

As you move higher in your career, you will present more often to different kinds of audiences.

There are two types of audiences:

- **Internal audience:** People inside your organization
- **External audience:** People outside your organization

Planning

Planning is the most important step. It includes analyzing your audience, selecting a topic, preparing graphics, planning time, and choosing a good location.

1. Audience Analysis

Understanding your audience helps you connect with them and deliver the message correctly.

Types of Audiences

- **High-tech audience:**
People with strong technical knowledge and education.
Example: Software engineers listening to a presentation on AI tools.
- **Low-tech audience:**
People with limited technical knowledge.
Example: Factory workers receiving training on safety rules.
- **Lay audience:**
General public with basic interest in the topic.
Example: Community members attending a health seminar.

Ways to Analyze an Audience

- **Preliminary Analysis (Before presentation):**
You study who the audience will be and prepare according to their knowledge level.
Example: If the audience is students, you include simple examples.*
- **Analysis During Presentation:**
You observe reactions while speaking and adjust accordingly.
Example: If people look confused, you slow down or give another example.*

2. Topic Selection

Sometimes you choose your own topic, but in business, your manager may assign it—like a progress

report or a solution to a problem.

After choosing the topic:

- Collect information
- Study related materials
- Prepare important points

Example:

If your topic is “Sales Growth,” you gather data, charts, and company statistics.

3. Graphic Aids

Graphics make information clearer and more engaging.

You can use software to create **charts, diagrams, infographics, pictures**, etc.

Example:

Showing a bar graph of yearly profits helps the audience understand the growth visually.

4. Location

You should know where you will present because it affects the tools you can use.

Examples:

- Outdoor construction site: projector may not work.
- Small room: demonstrating physical activities may be difficult.

5. Time

Every presentation has a time limit.

If the host doesn’t mention the time, always ask.

Example:

If you have 10 minutes, you must keep slides short and focused.

Speakers who talk too long usually lose the audience’s attention.

Stage Fright

It’s normal to feel nervous before speaking.

You cannot remove fear completely, but you can control it by:

- Preparing well
- Understanding your topic
- Practicing
- Knowing your audience
- Taking deep breaths
- Speaking slowly and clearly

Example:

A student practices their slides three times before class, which reduces nervousness.

Organizing and Composing a Presentation

When preparing a presentation, it is important to **organize and compose** it in a clear way so the audience does not feel confused. Good organization helps the audience follow your message easily.

There are two major steps:

1. **Selecting an organizational plan**
2. **Previewing the organization**

1. Selecting an Organizational Plan

Your presentation must be **clear and well-planned**.

Most presentations use the **direct approach**, but sometimes the **indirect approach** is better.

Direct Approach

In this method, you present the **main idea first**, and then explain it with details, examples, and evidence.

This approach:

- Tells listeners the topic immediately
- Shows what points will be covered
- Helps them follow the structure easily

Example:

"Today, I will explain why our company should adopt digital attendance. First, I'll show efficiency benefits, then cost savings, and finally accuracy improvements."

Indirect Approach

Use this when the audience is likely to **disagree** with your point.

Here, you:

- Build your argument slowly
- Present facts and evidence first
- Reveal the main point at the end

Example:

You show statistics about reduced productivity, then explain rising errors, and finally conclude by saying, "Therefore, we need digital attendance."

2. Previewing the Organization

No matter which plan you use, always give the audience a **preview** of what you will cover.

A preview acts like a **map**, showing:

- What the main points are
- What order they will follow

Example:

"In this presentation, I will discuss three points: the problem, our proposed solution, and the expected results."

Composing the Presentation

Listeners remember the **first** and **last** things they hear.

So, your introduction and conclusion must be strong.

A. Composing the Introduction

Depending on your audience and purpose, you may start with:

- **A direct quote from a well-known person**
Example: "As Steve Jobs said, 'Innovation distinguishes between a leader and a follower.'"
- **A rhetorical question** (no answer expected)
Example: "What would you do if your sales suddenly doubled?"
- **A surprising fact or statistic**
Example: "Over 70% of customers leave a website if it loads slowly."
- **A statement you later disprove**
Example: "Some people believe social media has no impact on business. Today, I will show why this is wrong."

B. Composing the Body

Follow these guidelines while preparing the main content:

- **Use simple, familiar words**
Example: Say "use" instead of "utilize."
- **Define any unfamiliar terms**
Example: "Cloud storage means saving files on the internet instead of your device."
- **Use shorter sentences than in written reports**
- **Highlight main points clearly**
- **Answer questions the audience might have**
- **Stay within the time limit**

C. Composing the Conclusion

The conclusion is important because it is the **final message** the audience will hear, so it needs careful planning.

A strong conclusion should:

- Keep the audience's attention
- Summarize the key points
- Call for action if needed

Example:

"To conclude, digital attendance saves time, reduces errors, and improves productivity. I recommend that we begin testing the system next month."

Preparing

After completing the planning process, we need to prepare our notes and personal appearance.

Good preparation helps ensure that we deliver an effective presentation. If we neglect preparation, the risks become high because relying only on memory can fail under stress.

Outlines and Notes

A well-practiced presentation supported by short notes creates a natural, conversational style. Using an outline, index cards, or paper notes helps us **talk to the audience**, not read to them.

For oral presentations, we should avoid long writing. We only write **key points**. Long paragraphs are only useful if we are preparing a written report.

An outline or notes should show each **main point** of the presentation.

Guidelines for Preparing Notes

- Do not write full sentences or long phrases.
Example: Write "Causes of delay – traffic, equipment failure" instead of full paragraphs.
- Prepare neat notes with enough empty (white) space.
Example: Leave margins so notes are easy to read at a glance.
- Structure notes uniformly using numbers, bullets, or outline format.
- If using note cards, write only **one idea per card**.
Example: Card 1: "Introduction"; Card 2: "Problem statement"; Card 3: "Solution".
- Number your notes or cards in the correct order from beginning to end.

Personal Appearance

When choosing clothing, consider the audience's expectations and the speaking situation. Feeling confident about your appearance helps you speak better. Whatever you select, ensure it is comfortable.

Example: For a presentation to managers, formal shirts and trousers may be appropriate; for a school workshop, smart-casual might be enough.

Rehearsing

Rehearsal is necessary for a successful presentation. Practice helps develop a smooth, conversational speaking style.

Using your note cards and graphic aids, rehearse your speech multiple times.

- In the first rehearsal, identify parts you like or dislike.
- In the second rehearsal, change what you do not like.
- When you feel comfortable with your delivery, you have practiced enough.

Speakers use different rehearsal methods such as:

- Audio recording
- A mirror
- Video camera
- A small live audience

With experience, you will know what works best for you.

Example: Practicing in front of a mirror can help you check your facial expressions and posture.

Presenting

Once preparation is complete, select a presentation method. There are three common methods: **memorizing**, **reading**, and **extemporaneous**.

Memorizing and reading are **not suitable** for technical presentations. The **extemporaneous method** is considered the best. In this method, the speaker rehearses in advance and then uses short guiding notes or PowerPoint slides to follow the structure and flow.

After finalizing the method, check the environment and present confidently.

Checking the Room

Arrive early at the presentation venue. Ensure that listeners can sit comfortably, see clearly, and hear well. Consider:

- Seating
- Lighting
- Temperature
- Equipment
- Graphic aids

Example: If the projector is too dim or the fan is too loud, fix it before starting.

Delivering the Message

To deliver an effective message, keep these points in mind:

- Use appropriate facial expressions.
- Maintain eye contact to show interest and concern.
- Explain every graphic or chart clearly.
- Look at your notes briefly, but do not read from them.
- Continue speaking calmly even if something goes wrong.
- Allow the audience to ask questions if time and program rules allow.

Organizing a Group Presentation

Presenting with others requires extra planning. Group presentations need teamwork, coordination, and clear communication.

Group members must work together to plan:

- The topic
- Time limits
- Transitions between speakers
- Graphic aids
- Handouts
- Question handling
- The overall structure

Dividing the Topic

Speakers must discuss roles and responsibilities. One important decision is **who will present which part**.

Example: One member explains the introduction, another handles data analysis, and another presents the conclusion.

Setting Time Limits

Just like an individual presenter, a group must stay within a set time limit. After the total time is fixed, members should divide the time based on each section's importance.

Example: In a 10-minute group presentation, Introduction (2 minutes), Data analysis (4 minutes), Conclusion (2 minutes), Q&A (2 minutes).

Moving Between Speakers

Speakers may:

- Have another person introduce them, or
- Introduce themselves, or
- Be introduced one by one before they begin

Choose the method that feels smooth and professional.

Providing Graphic Aids and Handouts

Group members should coordinate the appearance of slides and handouts. Consistency improves professionalism.

Example: All slides should use the same font, color theme, and layout.

Answering Questions

Some groups allow each speaker to answer questions after finishing their part. Others answer questions only after all speakers complete the entire presentation.

Decide in advance:

- Whether there will be a moderator
- Whether speakers will pick questions or be assigned questions

Example: A moderator might say, “This question will be answered by Ramesh, who handled the data section.”

Recommendation Reports

A recommendation report is a **problem-and-solution document**, a written response to a need that arises in the workplace. Most problems have more than one possible solution, and the recommendation report helps readers choose the **best** one. It guides people in solving both large and small issues—anything from constructing a building to selecting a new computer.

Example:

A company wants to reduce frequent network failures. Several solutions exist, such as upgrading routers, switching ISPs, or installing backup power. A recommendation report helps pick the best option.

Types of Recommendation Reports

1. Solicited reports (asked for)

In a solicited report, the reader has specifically asked you to analyze alternatives. This reader already understands the need and is more open to the suggestions.

Example:

The HR department asks you to compare three time-tracking systems and recommend one.

2. Unsolicited reports (not asked for)

In an unsolicited report, the audience is not expecting recommendations. They may still appreciate the initiative and find your insights helpful for decision-making.

Example:

An employee notices rising electricity costs and prepares a report recommending energy-saving measures, even though no one requested it.

Starting a Recommendation Report

After analyzing the audience, we must define the problem, brainstorm solutions, and set criteria.

Define the Problem

Clarify the problem by determining what needs to be analyzed, why the issue is important, who is involved, where it occurs, and when it started.

In a solicited report, the requester has already identified the problem.

Example:

The computer lab experiences slow boot times. The issue affects students, started last semester, and happens on older PCs. This needs examination.

Brainstorm Solutions

We may need others to help generate possible solutions. Explain the problem to colleagues and ask for their ideas. Mention that the goal is **creative problem-solving**, and that criticism will come later. Take notes as ideas appear, keep the group focused, prevent criticism, and narrow the list to two or three promising options.

We may also use advice from others to help with narrowing.

Example:

To fix the slow boot issue, colleagues suggest upgrading RAM, switching to SSDs, reinstalling the OS, or removing heavy startup programs. After discussion, the group narrows it down to SSDs and OS reinstallation.

Devise Criteria

As we narrow down the solutions, we need to decide what criteria to use. Interview people to understand what factors are important when choosing. Ask everyone involved—administration, workers, and people with experience using one of the solutions. Gathering opinions is important so the recommended solution works for everyone.

Example:

For the computer lab issue, criteria such as cost, installation time, long-term performance, and maintenance requirements are chosen after discussing with lab staff and the IT department.

Formatting and Organizing Recommendation Reports

A recommendation report is a **highly structured** problem-and-solution document. It uses a consistent outline and often a comparison/contrast discussion to show why one option is best. Choose the report format that best fits your audience (for example, an online format if readers prefer web access).

1. Standard Outline

A typical recommendation report contains these main sections:

Introduction

- States the purpose of the report.

Example: “This report compares three time-tracking systems to recommend the best one for our office.”

- Briefly explains the problem.
- Narrows the choices to two or three alternatives.
- Lists the criteria used for evaluation.

Example: “Criteria: cost, ease of use, integration, maintenance.”

- Previews the rest of the report.

Recommendation

- Clearly states the recommended option.
- Summarizes the main reasons using the chosen criteria.
Example: “Recommend System B because it meets our integration and maintenance needs at moderate cost.”

Scope

- Lists the evaluation criteria in order of importance (most to least).
- Explains why criteria were ranked that way.
Example: “Integration with existing payroll is most important because it reduces manual work.”

Discussion

- Analyzes each criterion in detail for each option.
- Draws conclusions about which option performs best on each criterion.
Example: “On cost: System A = low, System B = medium, System C = high.”

2. Comparison / Contrast Discussion (Point-by-Point)

Many recommendation reports use a **point-by-point** organization. This structure compares the same aspect of each option before moving to the next aspect (zigzag pattern).

Example layout (point-by-point):

Aspect	Option 1	Option 2
Safety	Good	Excellent
Functionality	Basic	Advanced
Cost	Low	Medium
Environmental Impact	Moderate	Low

This makes it easy for readers to compare options directly on each criterion.

3. Composing Recommendation Reports

When writing the report, focus on clarity, compactness, and reliability. The main steps are **setting criteria**, **evaluating criteria**, and **researching**.

Setting Criteria

- Choose criteria that matter to your audience and stakeholders.
- Each criterion needs:
 - A **rank** (how important it is relative to others).
 - A **standard** (how you will measure or limit the criterion).
- Use parallel wording (nouns or short question forms) for each criterion.
Good: Cost; Ease of integration; Maintenance requirements.
Bad: How much it costs; Can it be integrated easily?

Example: Rank: 1) Integration, 2) Cost, 3) Maintenance.

Evaluating Criteria

- Evaluate step-by-step for each option against every criterion.
- Ensure the data is **accurate, relevant, and sufficient**.
- Check logical order and enough supporting evidence.
- Verify tone and clarity for the intended audience.

Example: Provide a cost table and a maintenance-hours estimate to support conclusions.

Researching Criteria

- Use a mix of research methods:
 - **Field research:** surveys, interviews, site visits.
 - **Desk research:** manuals, catalogs, vendor specs, websites.
- Record sources and methods so readers can verify findings.

Example: Interview IT staff about integration experience; consult vendor datasheets for

compatibility specs.

4. Formatting Choices and Audience Needs

- Format should match reader preference (printed report, PDF, or online interactive report).
- Use clear headings, tables, and charts for comparisons.
- If readers use the Internet frequently, an online or linked format speeds access.

Example: Include a short executive summary at the top for busy managers, and a detailed appendix for technical staff.

Quick Checklist (before finalizing)

- Does the introduction state purpose and criteria?
- Are choices narrowed to 2–3 alternatives?
- Are criteria ranked and defined?
- Does the discussion compare options point-by-point?
- Is the recommendation clear and justified by the criteria?
- Are sources and research methods documented?
- Is the format suitable for the audience (print vs online)?

Proposals

A proposal is a formal document that **offers a solution** to a problem or a need.

Its main purpose is to **convince** or **persuade** the reader to accept an idea, a product, a service, or a plan.

Proposals can be **short** (1–2 pages) or **very long**, depending on the purpose.

People write proposals for many reasons:

- To sell a product or service
- To get approval for a plan
- To receive funding or grants
- To explain a research idea
- To complete academic degree requirements (research proposal)

Purposes of a Research Proposal

A research proposal is written to:

- Provide information about the research topic
- Prepare a clear research plan
- Justify why the research is important (its rationale)
- Form the basis for an agreement or contract
- Explain the research methodology
- Request approval or funding

Types of Technical Proposals

Technical proposals focus on **technology, engineering, science, or industrial activities**.

They are mainly of **four** types:

1. External Proposals

These are written for people **outside** the organization.

Examples of audience:

- Customers
- Government agencies
- Suppliers
- Service companies

Purpose:

- To sell a product or service
- To request financial support or grants

Short Example:

A software company writes a proposal to a hospital, offering to build a patient-record system.

2. Internal Proposals

These are written **within the organization** and stay inside the workplace.

Purpose:

- To propose a new idea, service, or product inside the company
- To address safety issues, system failures, technical problems, or workflow improvements

Short Example:

An employee proposes installing new security cameras in the office.

3. Solicited Proposals (Requested)

A solicited proposal is written **after someone asks for it**.

It may be internal, external, or personal.

When they are written:

- When a department issues a “Request for Proposals (RFP)”
- When a company asks you to explain how you can solve their problem
- When your college assigns you to write an academic proposal

Short Example:

A college asks students to write a research proposal for their final project.

This is a solicited proposal.

4. Unsolicited Proposals (Not Requested)

These are written **without being asked** by anyone.

The writer takes the initiative.

Purpose:

- To attract new customers
- To offer services to organizations that never requested them
- To introduce a new idea

Short Example:

A digital marketing company sends a proposal to a restaurant, offering to manage their social media—even though the restaurant never requested it.

5. Academic Proposals

These proposals are written by students to complete academic degrees.

Who writes them:

- Bachelor students
- Master’s (MA/MSc) students
- M.Phil students
- Ph.D. students

Purpose:

- To describe the research topic
- To explain method, objectives, and expected results
- To get approval before writing the full thesis

Short Example:

A student writes a proposal on “Machine Learning for Traffic Prediction” for their final year project.

Getting Started on Proposals

A proposal begins with identifying a **problem or need**.

This problem may be one you **discovered yourself** or one that **someone else pointed out**.

Problem-Solving Strategy for Proposals

To make writing a proposal easier and focused, follow these steps:

1. **Determine the problem or need**
Example: A company notices their website traffic is low.
2. **Conduct preliminary research**
Example: Check competitor websites, online trends, or customer feedback.
3. **Determine the scope and limitations**
Example: Focus only on improving social media traffic, not all marketing channels.
4. **Brainstorm possible solutions**
Example: Improve website SEO, create social media campaigns, or run paid ads.
5. **Gather data to support solutions**
Example: Show statistics of social media engagement and ROI from previous campaigns.
6. **Test and evaluate solutions (if possible)**
Example: Run a small trial Facebook ad campaign to see results before full launch.

Composing Informal Proposals

Informal proposals are written for **less formal situations**. They are often **unsolicited**, meaning the audience did not request them.

Purpose: Inform the audience about **available services or products**.

Structure of an Informal Proposal

1. **Executive Summary (Abstract)**
 - Designed for busy decision-makers.
 - Appears at the beginning of the proposal (sometimes on the title page).
 - Includes:
 - Problem statement
 - Proposed objectives
 - Project impact
 - Work plan
 - **Example:** “Our proposal aims to increase website traffic by 25% over three months through targeted social media campaigns.”
2. **Introduction**
 - Answers “**why**” the proposal was written.
 - Explains the **problem** and gives a **brief solution**.
 - **Example:** “Website traffic is low, affecting online sales. Our plan is to improve social media presence to increase engagement.”
3. **Body**
 - Provides **specific details** to persuade the audience:
 - Facts, figures, statistics
 - Dates, locations, and costs
 - **Example:** “The campaign will run from December 1 to February 28, with a budget of \$1,500 allocated to Facebook and Instagram ads. Expected reach: 50,000 users.”
4. **Conclusion**
 - Should be **straightforward and brief**.

- Summarizes key points and calls the audience to action.
- Include **specific instructions, deadlines, or amounts**.
- **Example:** "Approve the campaign budget of \$1,500 by November 25 so we can launch on December 1."

Composing Formal Proposals

Formal proposals are **similar to informal proposals** but differ in tone, complexity, and additional sections:

Key Differences:

- **Tone:** Professional and official.
- **Extra Sections:** Glossary, appendices, transmittal letters.
- **Complexity:** Used for big projects like building a new lab or launching a new software product.

Components of a Formal Proposal

1. Cover Letter

- A short letter giving extra information about your proposal.
- Addressed to the decision-maker.
- **Example:**
"Dear Principal, Please find attached my proposal for introducing a school recycling program. I hope this initiative will benefit both students and the environment."

2. Title Page

- Includes: Proposal title, your name, institution, and registration number.
- **Example:**

A Proposal on School Recycling Program
Submitted by: Sita Sharma
BSc Environmental Science, TU
TU Regd. Number: 12345
Submitted to: Kathmandu High School
Kathmandu, Nepal

3. Table of Contents

- Lists all sections with page numbers.
- **Example:**

CONTENTS	
Chapter 1: Introduction	2
1.1 Background	2
1.2 Purpose	3
1.3 Problem Statement	4
Chapter 2: Proposed Solution	5
Chapter 3: Budget	6
Chapter 4: Timeline	7

4. Executive Summary

- A brief overview of the proposal.
- Shows main points at a glance.
- **Example:**
"This proposal suggests starting a school recycling program. It aims to reduce waste, educate students on environmental issues, and create a cleaner campus. Activities include separate bins for paper, plastic, and organic waste, weekly monitoring, and student awareness campaigns."

5. Main Body

- Includes:
 - **Introduction** – Explains problem and purpose
 - **Literature Review** – Short review of similar programs
 - **Methodology** – How you will implement the plan
 - **Analysis & Findings** – Expected results
 - **Conclusion** – Final recommendations
- **Example:**
"The recycling program will be implemented in all classrooms. Weekly audits will track progress. Students will be encouraged to participate through competitions and rewards."

6. Personal or Company Profile

- Gives info about yourself or your organization.
- **Example:**
"Sita Sharma, BSc Environmental Science student at TU, has experience in school environmental projects and community clean-up programs."

7. Budget

- List all costs clearly.
- **Example:**

Budget:

- Recycling bins: \$200
- Posters & Awareness Materials: \$50
- Student Rewards: \$30
Total: \$280

8. Time Frame

- Mention activity and duration.
- **Example:**

Time Frame:

- Planning: 1 week
- Setup: 2 weeks
- Monitoring: 4 weeks

9. References

- List all sources used in the proposal.
- **Example:**

References:

- Sharma, R. (2020). Environmental Awareness in Schools. Kathmandu Press.
- Singh, P. (2018). Waste Management Techniques. Pokhara University.

10. Appendices

- Include extra supporting material like charts, surveys, or diagrams.
- **Example:** Survey of students' interest in recycling, layout plan for bin placement.

Ethics in the Workplace

Ethics are the principles and values that help people decide what is right or wrong. A system of ethics, or morality, is based on values that guide a person's actions. Many people share similar values, such as honesty, fairness, hard work, and equality.

Example: If a stranger drops a 100-rupee note on the street, your ethics might guide you to return it instead of keeping it.

Benefits of Ethical Decisions

Acting ethically has many benefits:

- **Respect and privileges:** Ethical behavior earns respect and access to societal privileges, like voting, borrowing money, or holding public office.
- **Peace of mind:** It keeps a person's conscience clear and reduces guilt.
- **Character definition:** Ethics show the kind of person someone is.

Example: A worker reporting a safety violation at the company gains respect and trust from colleagues and management.

Consequences of Unethical Behavior

Unethical behavior can lead to serious consequences:

- Legal trouble, such as fines or convictions.
- Damage to personal and professional reputation.
- Guilt and stress.
- Negative impact on family, coworkers, and society.

Example: Falsifying financial records might get a person fired and also hurt coworkers or clients who rely on accurate information.

Creating a Culture of Ethics

Culture is the set of social norms and experiences that guide human behavior. Workplace ethics can be maintained by:

1. **Ethical Leadership:** Leaders influence employees to act ethically by showing purpose, values, and direction.
Example: A manager who refuses to favor friends for promotions encourages fair treatment for all.
2. **Writing a Code of Ethics:** Companies can create a written code to guide employees' behavior.
 - **Personal Code:** Reflect on your own values and standards.
Example: Always prioritize honesty and transparency in communications.
 - **Corporate Code:** Collaboratively create rules for ethical behavior in the company.
Example Questions:
 - What are the company's core values?
 - What ethical conflicts might employees face?

What to Do When Faced with an Ethical Dilemma

An **ethical dilemma** is a situation where you must choose between two or more options, and each option has a moral consequence. In other words, it's a situation where it's not clear what the "right" or "wrong" choice is.

Imagine you find a wallet on the street with money inside.

- **Option 1:** Keep the money → You benefit, but it's dishonest.
- **Option 2:** Return the wallet to the owner → It's honest, but you lose the money.

Preventing Ethical Conflicts

The best way to avoid ethical dilemmas is to:

- Act honestly and transparently.
- Discuss decisions with people you trust.
- Follow your personal values.
- Understand and respect the values of your organization.

Example: Before approving a project, a manager consults team members to ensure the plan is fair and legal.

Clarify Your Position

Before deciding, ask yourself:

- Would my actions be legal?
- Have I thought about the consequences?
- How uncomfortable does this make me?
- Is there an obvious solution?

Example: If a coworker asks you to falsify a report, you consider legality, potential consequences, and your discomfort.

Analyze the Ethical Dilemma

- Take time to understand the situation.
- Examine all facts carefully.
- Clarify your short-term and long-term goals.
- Talk to someone you trust.
- Explore alternative solutions.

Example: If a supplier offers a bribe, you review company policies, consider reporting options, and discuss with a senior mentor.

Choose a Responsible Course of Action

Use these criteria to guide your decision:

1. **Rights:** Will my actions respect the rights of others?
2. **Justice:** Are my actions fair?
3. **Utility:** Will this benefit the most people?
4. **Care:** Do my actions show concern for others?
5. **Empathy:** Can I understand how others feel?
6. **Consistency:** Is this consistent with my previous actions?
7. **Values & Principles:** Does this align with my personal and professional values?

Example: Choosing to report a coworker's unethical behavior protects company integrity and respects everyone's rights.

Why Ethical Decisions Are Difficult

- Unethical behaviors are often subtle and go unnoticed.
- Ethics depend on time, place, situation, and personal beliefs.
- Laws cannot cover every unethical action.

Example: A manager favors one employee over others for small tasks. It may seem minor, but it can hurt team morale and fairness.

Defense Mechanisms Against Unethical Behavior

1. **Bandwagon:** Don't do something just because everyone else is doing it.
2. **Denial:** Reject unethical actions and choose ethical ones.
3. **Rationalization:** Avoid making excuses for unethical behavior.
4. **False Sense of Security:** Take responsibility for your actions.
5. **Stress:** Separate stress management from moral decisions.
6. **Revenge:** Don't justify unethical actions as "payback."
7. **Blame:** Own the situation and act responsibly, even if it wasn't your fault.

Example: If a colleague pressures you to falsify a report:

- Don't follow the crowd (**bandwagon**)
- Don't make excuses (**rationalization**)
- Take responsible action, such as reporting it (**blame/responsibility**)